

OREGON CITY COURIER

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WAR'S HEAVY TOLL

All the wars that ever were are not justification for the tears from one good woman's heart. And all real tears come from the heart. The tears that mothers, wives and sisters shed for war are war's most sad feature; to still the hearts that weep is a greater cause than any that ever inspired bloodshed on the most honorable battlefield the world has known.

If men with human hearts made war there would be no war. There is not a man, deserving of that honorable distinction, upon whom the sadness that comes from war would not weigh as a burden too heavy to bear; too awful to permit—and undoubtedly there would be no war.

After all, it is the mother, the wife and the sister who bear war's loads. The mother's tears slack the soil upon the grave of son that the purity of soul that inspired those tears may lend refreshment in another life somewhere, sometime to the body that rests beneath.

The tears that a good wife sheds; to keep them shut in their harbor of love in the recesses of a great heart is a far more worthy aim than democracy, than the freedom of the seas. And that the last forlorn clasp in the arms of an affectionate sister might not be the lot of the men who fight—that would be the will of the Master.

But in civilization's scheme of affairs the bullets are more worthy than the tears. The freedom of the seas is immensely more desirable than the brotherhood of man—or is it the brotherhood of man that makes us fight? We do our bit and go about it graciously because the gods that rule our lives so will it, and to be a traitor is to be ignominiously dead. But mankind will come to that glorious day when all genius, all power will be directed toward the everlasting incultation of the spirit of brotherhood; to that day when love shall rule the world in hate's place; when tears shall be unknown; when civilization shall be real.

Then shall come the dawn. It shall shed its pretty lights upon the battlefields of another day, upon the graves of heroes of the past. The time of warfare shall be history. The future shall be peace. Love, happiness and progress shall be the guiding stars of humanity. The moonbeams shall write "good will" upon the gravestones of another age; the graves of the new years will be marked by the flowers of loving kindness and the soldiers will be they who serve well their home and their loved ones, and thereby serve well their world—for war shall be forgotten and the kingdom of God shall be known to mortal man.

DRAW THE LINE TIGHT

A large number of the leading members of the house of representatives at Washington are opposed to the censorship section of the espionage bill, and although various reasons are assigned for the position taken, there is enough room to believe that most, if not all, of them are seeking favor in the eyes of certain newspapers over the country.

Speaker Clark claims that he is firmly convinced that the press censorship is a frank violation of the constitution of the United States, and "the fact that editors slander people, abuse them like pickpockets and lie about them for doing their plain duty—and in the last ten days I received as much of that as anybody—will not make me vote for what I do not believe is constitutional." The speaker no doubt is heaping coals of fire on certain heads in and around Washington.

Representative Kahn of California is of the belief that it "is our plain duty to the American press to credit them with motives as highly patriotic as our own and treat them as friends and not as criminals to be dealt with on the same plane as secret intriguers, conspirators, plotters and spies." Mr. Kahn is evidently catering to the wishes of a certain Californian newspaper that has been

waging war on the censorship section for the past week. This newspaper, like many others in this country, has only a selfish motive behind its enterprise. It has not been so long ago since this same newspaper printed photographs of government fortifications taken from an airship and at a time when trouble with a foreign power was imminent, and this in direct violation of the laws of the land. The editor of the paper had rather wreck the government than to have to submit to the will of the majority if that will is not in accord with his own.

Some newspapers, like some individuals, are irresponsible at times. They want to tell all they know whether good or bad for the weal of the nation. In crises like these there is only one thing to be done and that is put a limit on what can be printed. No man or newspaper is bigger than his country and he should be sensible enough to realize that what is for the best interests of the country will be for his own best interests. For the time being selfish interests must be put aside and the greatest good to the greatest number be done.

"Free press and free speech" are all right, but there is a line beyond which no one should be allowed to go, whether bondman or free and congress should draw that line and draw it without hesitancy or trying to play to the sympathies of those who would abuse their powers and privileges. Eugene Guard.

WHY THEY SMILE

People profoundly interested in animals are often the recipients of a compassionate smile. To those who have little comprehension of the nature of the humane movement this work appears to be something quite unworthy the consideration of serious men and women. Hence the compassionate smile.

This is chiefly due to an entire failure to understand how vitally related to the development of human character is man's right attitude to the creatures below him. Beyond all the measureless blessing that has come to animals through the activities of humane societies has been the ennobling influence upon the men, women and children who have felt the quickening power of the spirit of this wider humanity. Educators, teachers of every class who have given the subject careful thought, have universally recognized the refining force of such training as awakens in a human soul a generous response to the call of the weak, the oppressed, the suffering. No man closes his heart to the great fact of the world's pain, by whatever creature endured, who does not by that very act dwarf and deaden his whole moral nature. Civilization has risen just in proportion as men have become sensitive and responsive to whatever stirred their finer, more unselfish feelings.

This spirit of the wider humanity is but the spirit of every noble religion, reaching out till it blesses the whole realm of sentient life. The humane movement has been the great factor in teaching mankind that it falls short of its highest until it has included in its circle every creature of the good God—even the sparrow whose fall the Eternal marks.

A DRY NATION

In its work of gathering into Bands of Mercy more than four million children, inculcating the spirit of good will, justice and kindness to one's fellows and to defenseless animals as well, the American Humane Education society has done vastly more for these children in their moral lives than it has been able to do for the animals. This is why we know our work is on the same high level with all those saving institutions of society like the church and the school, and those other organizations whose aim is the refining and ennobling of life—Dumb Animals.

The serious student of American affairs is already asking: "What of the future? What compensation

will America receive for the sacrifices that must be made?"

Answers will vary widely, of course, but is it not reasonable to believe that one of the big—real big blessings that will come to our people from their spendings of treasure and blood will be a dry nation, asks the Rogue River Courier.

When such hard-headed men of affairs as Howard Elliott, president of the New Haven railroad, Frank A. Vanderlip, president of one of New York's largest banks and the president of the U. S. Steel corporation, petition congress for national prohibition it means that there is a real need for the change. If this nation is to do anywhere near its share in the struggle for world-wide democracy it must be efficient. And no nation can be efficient and intemperate.

Congress has passed a law providing for mobilizing the manhood of the country into fighting and working armies. Under this law every citizen is subject to being drafted into service where most needed. If the demand for unity of action dictates that the authorities may direct where and how each man's bit shall be rendered why should not the same authority dictate that it shall be as valuable as possible? And no sensible person will deny that an enforced national temperance is the longest possible step to a maximum increase in efficiency all along the line.

We are urged to produce the very limit in foodstuffs. The situation is alarming; but why not shut the granary door after we fill it instead of allowing 100,000,000 bushels of grain to go into a nationally enervating beverage?

"It's an ill wind that blows nobody good." If our participation in the war brings a dry nation, the sacrifice will not have been in vain.

AT OLD CHAMPOEG

Clackamas County Folk Gather to Honor Pioneers

Because he was on the ground at the great annual pilgrimage to Champoege, the Courier reprints from the Telegram David Hazen's account of the trip. Many Clackamas county and Oregon City folk were present. Mr. Hazen says:

Champoege town is hardly a memory any more. An ancient store building, now boarded up; an old shop that is now an atelier; a house or two, and near the river landing a roughly constructed warehouse. "There's a long, long trail" running through the site of the once prosperous village. This is the old main-traveled highway between the towns of the lower and upper Willamette valley. Champoege was the half-way place for the stages running between Portland and Salem.

But although Champoege town is only a place of yesterdays, it will live in history long after thriving cities of today have been forgotten. At Champoege on a fair May day 74 years ago the Oregon republic was born. And to celebrate this great event of May 2, 1843, several hundred citizens of the Oregon commonwealth, a small political division of the old Oregon republic, gathered last Saturday and honored the memories of the 62 men who followed Joe Meek's waving cap to the side of independent government.

It was a beautiful afternoon—as "rare" as an afternoon as the poet Lowell's famous day in June. The Fernwood band, the wheel-of-fortune man, the toy balloon seller and the beautiful steamboat at the nearby landing added a touch of modernness to the scene that one quickly forgot by stealing away into the woods and recalling pioneer days and ways. All of those who took part in Champoege's great day have passed by still waters, but a number of the children and grandchildren of the men whose names are carved on the modest monument that marks the site of the divide were present. Mrs. A. Burton and John F. Matthien, daughter and son of F. X. Matthien; J. U. Smith, son of Sidney Smith; and J. E. and Abner Lewis, sons of Reuben Lewis, were present.

For many years, Oregonians have gone to Champoege on May 2 to pay a tribute to the founders of our state. This year it was decided to hold the celebration on the first Saturday following the second in order to allow teachers and school children to attend.

This was the first time that the youngsters had taken part in these exercises. They sang a number of songs, including the "Star-Spangled Banner"; before this song each child stepped forward and stated the nationality of his or her grandparents; the map of Europe was carried to Champoege Saturday.

The Portland and Oregon City delegation went up on the flagship of the Gramah fleet of river packets, the Gramahona, returning on the Pomona. Captain A. B. Graham, who began making pilgrimages to Champoege when the town was still there, made the trip. Captain Graham has sailed under goosewinged-topsails on the clippers of the Black Ball line, and he has stayed awake o' nights off Good Hope trying to get a peek at the Flying Dutchman, but then A. B. is still a boy when compared with another mariner who went up the river Saturday—William Howard Hardy, who accompanied Commodore M. C. Perry to Japan.

Dressed in the garb of a jack-tar

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OPENING THE BIBLE

When the President Takes the Oath of Office.

NO PLACE FIXED IN ADVANCE.

The Passage of Scripture Upon Which the Chief Executive Presses His Lips is Entirely a Matter of Chance—The Bible After the Ceremony.

The president before he enters on the execution of his office takes an oath or affirmation that he "will faithfully execute the office of president of the United States and will, to the best of my ability, preserve, protect and defend the constitution of the United States," and this oath is usually sealed or confirmed by the kissing of the Bible.

The kissing of the Bible as part of the inaugural ceremony is perhaps following a very ancient custom. The Egyptians were required to kiss the rolls on which the commands of Joseph were written.

The custom requires that immediately after the president elect has taken the oath, with hand on the Bible, the clerk of the United States supreme court shall throw open the book, and the incoming chief magistrate shall implant a kiss on one of its open pages.

Doubting Thomases have always thought that there was no element of chance in this performance and that the passage of Scripture is always carefully selected in advance, and the book is held by the clerk of the court in position so that the incoming chief will kiss the passage that it is intended he shall kiss, but this supposition is entirely wrong.

James D. Maher, clerk of the supreme court, said that the opening of the book is entirely "haphazard" and that no man on earth has the slightest intimation in advance regarding the passage of Scripture that will be thus brought into notice.

Usually the Bible that is used in administering the oath is bought by the clerk of the supreme court and paid for out of his pocket and is a small Oxford edition costing \$10 to \$15. The late James H. McKimley, for many years clerk of the supreme court, once said, "You see, congress expends money only by appropriation, and if we were to wait for congress to appropriate the price of the book we might never get a Bible on time."

There have been exceptions, however, when the Bible came from other sources. For instance, when James A. Garfield was inaugurated March 4, 1881, he carried in his overcoat pocket to the capitol a well worn, leather bound volume which had been presented to him by his mother. The book was taken from the White House and in a few years found its way to the stall of a bookseller in San Francisco. How it got there has never been known, nor is it likely it ever will be. A few years ago it was offered for sale at a very high price.

Chester A. Arthur took the oath of office just after midnight at his home in New York city Sept. 20, 1881. The Bible used was one belonging to the then chief justice of the state of New York. It is cherished by the judge's family as an heirloom.

On March 4, 1885, when Grover Cleveland was inaugurated president for the first time, he, like Garfield, kissed the Holy Book which was given to him by his mother. It was a small volume, bound in red leather, and was presented to him many years before. The book is now in the possession of Mr. Cleveland's married sister at Toledo, O. The Bible upon which he took the oath in 1893, eight years later when he became president the second time, was one presented by his beautiful wife, and she became its possessor.

When Benjamin Harrison was made president March 4, 1889, the Bible used was one that his wife had given him on the day of their marriage in Oxford, O., where President Harrison spent his school days. The Harrison Bible is owned by Mrs. James R. McKimley, the daughter of ex-President Harrison.

President McKimley used a Bible that had been presented to him by the negro bishops of the country. It was the biggest Bible ever seen at the clerk's office, and Clerk McKimley in relating the incident said: "The day before the inauguration one of the bishops called at my office with the Bible. It was a huge affair of the type known as family Bibles. It rested in an ornate box lined with purple velvet and ornamented with gold. The box was fastened by lock and key. When I realized that it would be my lot to carry that huge Bible from the senate chamber clear out to the front of the capitol my knees grew weak and I could not refrain from asking the bishop jokingly where the wheelbarrow was that should go with it."

The inevitable custom is that on the day following the inauguration the clerk of the court takes the Bible to the White House and presents it to the first lady of the land as a keepsake—Exchange.

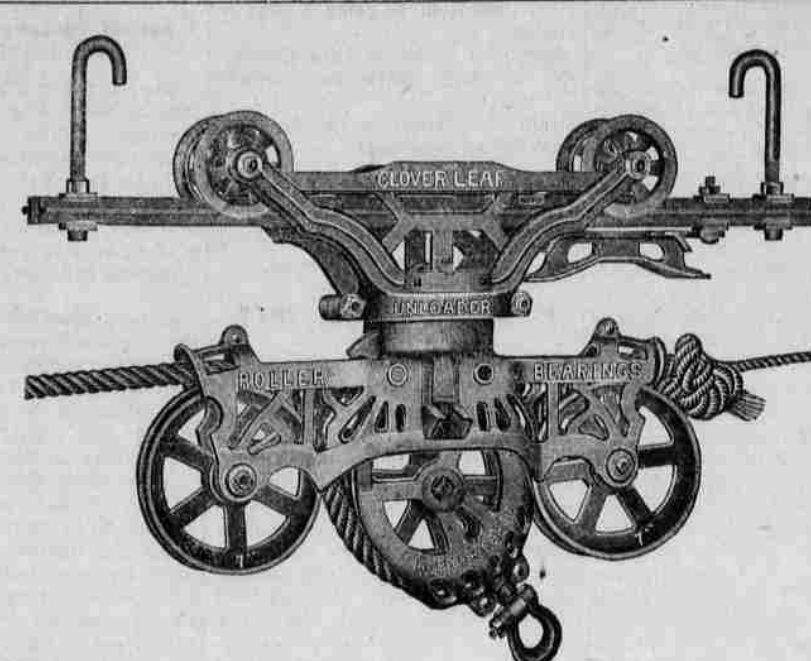
Re-enforced Concrete.

The ark in which Moses was placed in the bulrushes, we are told in the second chapter of Exodus, was an ark of bulrushes daubed with slime and with pitch. This is probably the first recorded instance of a re-enforced concrete structure.

In matters of conscience first thoughts are best; in matters of prudence last thoughts are best.

of the '50s, his long beard and hair the sport of the gentle May breeze, Captain Hardy was the lion of the hour among the country folk who had never seen him before. He kissed babies, shook hands with scores of grown-ups and wrote his autograph for pretty school girls "who had read about him." Hardy also made a speech, pleading for a better understanding between Americans and "America's friend in the Orient—Japan."

There were many speeches made Saturday, but all were short. Gov.



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ernoor Withycombe, Senator W. D. Wood of Washington county; P. H. D'Arcy of Salem; J. U. Smith of Newberg; former Governor T. T. Geer, C. B. Moores, Senator Milton A. Miller and others told of days before the Indians had ceased to be a menace and beaver skins were more sought after than gold.

The Veterans' quartet of Portland and the Fernwood band of Yamhill county added to the afternoon's delight. George H. Himes, who carries around in his brain more Oregon history than has ever been transcribed into books, was present, and told and retold to the younger generation the story of May 2, 1843.

Next year will be the 75th anniversary of the establishing of the Oregon republic. Steps should be taken towards making this celebration the greatest meeting ever held at Champoege since Joe Meek waved his cap and called to all who favored the American form of government to follow him. The legislature last winter appropriated \$5000 to build a hall on the grounds; this will be done during the summer, so no matter whether the day be dark or delightful, the exercises can be held. The celebration should be different from those in the past. J. U. Smith suggested that the Portland school children present a play that pictured the dramatic scenes of the famous meeting; this, with a carefully prepared address by some well-known author or nationally prominent orator, would make the day a notable one.

But from now until then, old Champoege's historic field will be deserted, save for the shades of departed warrior whom legend tells us re-visit on moonlight nights the green waters that flow by the meadows, the green waters these warriors called Wil-lam-ette.

GIRLS WILL FLOW

Secure Land for Cultivation. To Join in G. A. R. Parade

Eighty acres of choice land near Elwood has been turned over to the uses of the Girls' Honor Guard by J. Schwerin and at last gives the young women a place for the exercise of their agricultural talents. At the meeting of the Guard Tuesday night several plots of ground were donated to their use. The Logus tracts at Greenpoint will be cultivated and a number of lots at Gladstone owned by H. E. Cross will be put in crop. At Mountain View O. D. Eby has been instrumental in securing land for the girls to plow. The 80-acre Schwerin tract will be cultivated on shares. O. E. Freytag, who was in charge of Clackamas county's display at San Francisco, will give his services toward assisting the Guard.

Miss Rose Price, chairman of the paper day committee, reported that \$17.50 had been earned on the first sale. Paper will be gathered again next week and sold to the Crown-Wil-Lamette Paper company on the last Saturday of the month.

The Guard will join in a Memorial day parade with the G. A. R. Dr. Roy A. Prudden last night led the girls in singing patriotic airs. Some time was taken by Harvey Starkweather in explaining the road bond issue and asking its favor from

the guard as a patriotic movement. Reports were made by Miss Merle Dimick, in charge of the branch of the Guard at Hubbard and by Miss Cis Pratt, president of the local chapter. Miss Pratt asked for greater interest in corps number 2, which has charge of charitable work among the families of men who have gone to the service of the country.

ALIENS ARE LOYAL

Only 125 Alien Enemies Have Been Arrested Under New Ruling

High praise for America's foreign born citizens is given by Attorney General Gregory in a statement revealing that only 125 alien enemies have been arrested under the president's proclamation.

About half of those arrested were charged with espionage or attempt to foment disloyalty or disorder. The attorney general renews the admonition that alien residents exercise scrupulous care in their daily activities, and reiterates that the vigilance of the government agents has not been relaxed.

"The foreign born citizens of America as a class," the statement says, "deserve the highest commendation and praise for the manner in which they have conducted themselves. As regards law and order, they have in almost all instances vindicated the president's oft-repeated assertion that he had not misgivings as to how foreign born Americans would measure up to their responsibilities and duties in the event of a national crisis."

LICENSE WON'T HOLD

Mr. King Recalls Bicycle Path Bill and Ramps on Bonds

Oregon City, May 7; to the editor: The state of Oregon is practically the only state of any great natural wealth and beautiful scenery not yet exploited by the bondholding class, as it is as yet without any state debt practically.

Yet we have today a bunch of men howling their heads off in order to get the people to vote themselves into bondage that they (the bunch and their cohorts) may have pleasure roads to travel over while the farmer gets to town the best he can. One of their stock arguments is the

value of good roads to the farmer. A good road is a boon to the farmers, but the argument used in connection with the bond issue is false pretense, in that its intent is to make the farmer believe the proceeds of the bond issue will be used for his benefit when the exact reverse is true, a comparatively small number of farmers will be benefited.

Another argument, and this seems to be the main one that they rely on is "that the auto license when coupled with the millage tax for road purposes will pay the whole bill." Let us see: Aliense, to be legal, must be regulatory or registrative in its action. The tax or license, whichever you call it, is clearly not regulatory in its purpose, therefore it must be for registrative purposes, and if such is the case will lay itself open to the charge that it is excessive for the purpose and will fall under the first attack. Take the bicycle tax or license law. Where is it today? Is it in force? No. Why? For the above reason. It was planned by the framers of the law to build bicycle paths with the license funds just as they propose to pay interest and bonds with the auto license funds.

Yet when attacked on the ground stated it went down and so will your auto license lay go down when attacked from the same standpoint. If your license is neither registrative nor regulatory then it becomes taxation and causes double taxation.

Red Cross to Elect

For the purpose of perfecting an organization, all members of the local branch of the Portland Red Cross chapter have been called to attend a meeting this evening at the Commercial club. The election of permanent officers is expected to attract considerable attention. In its campaign for members on Saturday the Red Cross was highly successful and brought many dollars into the treasury after a day of active solicitation.

Thomas Wants Money

Henry M. Thomas changes, in a complaint filed here Tuesday against Walter S. and Lola Thomas, that he loaned the couple \$1166 more than five years ago and that the sum has never been repaid. The loan, Thomas says, was to be repaid upon the sale of Wallowa county land within five years.

FEWER PEOPLE GROWING OLDER

The Public Health Service reports that more people live to the age of forty years to-day, but from forty to sixty years mortality is increasing from degenerative diseases.

Thousands of well-informed men and women to-day are learning the true value of

SCOTT'S EMULSION

OF NORWEGIAN COD LIVER OIL

as a powerful blood-enricher and strength-builder to ward off the headaches and backaches that mean weakness. SCOTT'S helps fortify the body against grippe, pneumonia and weakening colds, through its force of medicinal nourishment.

Refuse Alcoholic Extracts That Do Not Contain Cod Liver Oil.

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In increasing production of necessary things and decreasing consumption of those which are unnecessary the facilities and services of The Bank of Oregon City will be found available—and HELPFUL.

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